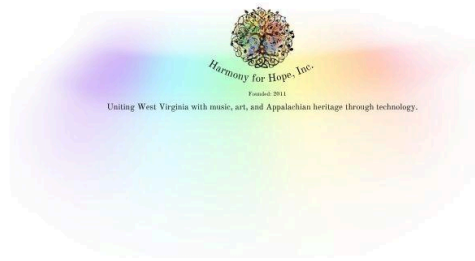


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Mount Hope Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Pilot

Council Information Packet

Submitted by: Harmony for Hope, Inc.

In partnership with: Kidd's Technical Services

Contact: Carrie Kidd, Harmony for Hope

Email: ckidd@harmonyforhopewv.org

Project documentation: <https://github.com/H4HWV2011/msjarvis-public-docs>

What Is Being Requested

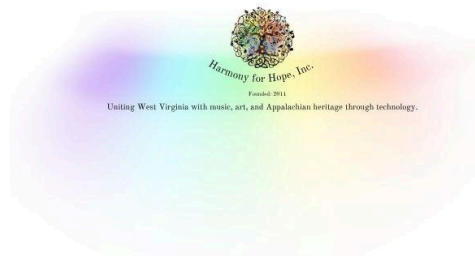
Harmony for Hope is requesting that the City of Mount Hope provide a **Letter of Support** for the Mount Hope Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Pilot — a community heritage and connectivity initiative being advanced for grant applications and partnership development with New River Gorge National Park and Preserve.

No municipal funding is requested. No installation or site authorization is requested at this stage. This is a concept support letter only.

About Harmony for Hope

Harmony for Hope, Inc. is a nonprofit organization based at 706–708 Main Street in Mount Hope. Harmony for Hope operates as the program sponsor for MountainShares, a community-owned local economy and heritage platform being developed in southern West Virginia. Harmony for Hope has established the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail — a 1.25-mile route through sixteen points of architectural significance that traces Mount Hope's evolution from Native American pathways to company town to modern coalfield municipality.

The technical infrastructure for this project is developed and operated by Kidd's Technical Services under contract to Harmony for Hope. The technology platform — the Artificial



Learning & Location Intelligence System (ALLIS) — is owned and operated by Kidd's Technical Services. MountainShares, the community economy and heritage application, is owned and operated by Harmony for Hope. The Heritage Mesh Pilot brings both together in Mount Hope and the surrounding New River Gorge corridor.

The Project: Mount Hope as the Anchor

The New River Gorge Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Mesh Pilot is a corridor-scale heritage and connectivity initiative serving gateway communities along the 53-mile New River Gorge corridor. The pilot begins with two communities:

- **Mount Hope** — the lead anchor community, where Harmony for Hope already operates, the Historic Walking Trail is already established, and the infrastructure backbone can be deployed from Harmony for Hope's own property at 704–708 Main Street.
- **Thurmond** — a complementary NPS-managed rail preservation site where a second node would extend the corridor connection, subject to NPS permitting and review.

Mount Hope is not secondary to Thurmond. Mount Hope is the reference implementation — the place where this model is built, tested, and proven before it travels to other communities in the corridor.

What the Technology Does

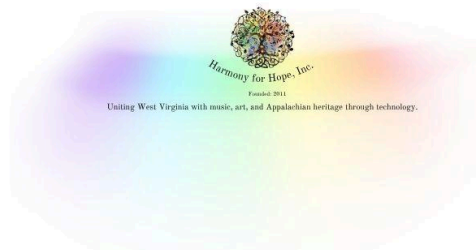
Each community in the pilot hosts an **ALLIS node** — a small, locally hosted intelligence platform that stores heritage content, trail data, visitor information, and safety guidance on-site. The system is identified as **MS.MHHWT.ALLIS** for the Mount Hope Historic Walking Trail deployment.

When a visitor connects to a Mount Hope ALLIS node:

- They connect to locally hosted content — heritage stories, walking trail interpretation, maps, and safety information — even when cellular service is limited or absent.

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- They access interpretive material developed by Harmony for Hope, NPS, and local partners in formats that deepen what printed signs and brochures can introduce.
- They can participate in the MountainShares local economy platform — discovering local businesses, community services, and contributing to the commons.

The system is designed to serve residents as well as visitors. Weather alerts, road closures, community event information, and local resources can all be delivered through the same infrastructure that supports the walking trail.

Why Mount Hope Is the Right Lead Community

Mount Hope is the right anchor for this pilot because of what already exists here:

- **Harmony for Hope at 706–708 Main Street** — an operating nonprofit with a physical presence, existing community relationships, and an established heritage mission.
- **The Historic Walking Trail** — a 1.25-mile signed path with 48 interpretive signs, complemented by a brochure-guided tour of 16 architectural and heritage points of interest throughout town.
- **The Fayette County Community Arts Center** — a cultural anchor institution within the same short block of Main Street.
- **An established relationship with New River Gorge National Park** — the Park has indicated conceptual support for the corridor initiative and specifically noted that Mount Hope community support is essential before NPS can formally engage.

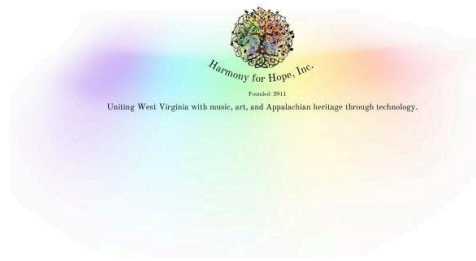
A Letter of Support from Mount Hope strengthens the project's ability to:

1. Obtain grant funding from the Appalachian Regional Commission, USDA Rural Development, and EDA.
2. Formalize NPS engagement at Thurmond and in the broader corridor.
3. Extend invitations to Fayetteville, Oak Hill, Hinton, and Ansted as subsequent corridor nodes.

Mount Hope's letter is the first domino. Other communities and partners are waiting to see it fall.

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The Cost and Commitment Model

Community partners in this program do not pay for participation. Harmony for Hope, through the MountainShares Sponsorship Tier, covers the cost of hardware installation and ongoing operation at no cost to the host community. The City of Mount Hope's contribution, if it chooses to host a node, would be:

- Site access for appropriate hardware placement (to be determined collaboratively).
- A point of contact for coordination.
- Participation in evaluation and feedback.

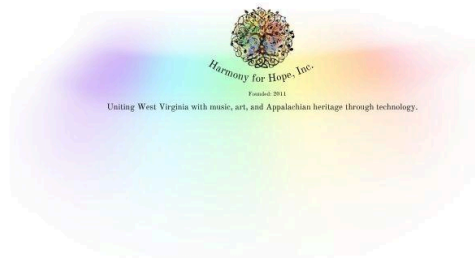
Every participating community executes a simple Corridor Partner Community Governance Agreement with Kidd's Technical Services. That agreement:

- Confirms the no-cost deployment model.
- Protects locally generated heritage and operational data as a community resource.
- Preserves the partner's intellectual property rights over content they contribute.
- Allows termination with notice, with hardware removal and surface restoration included.

The City of Mount Hope is not being asked to pay for, manage, or take technical responsibility for this infrastructure.

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Project Status

Element	Status
Technology platform (Ms. Allis)	Live and in active testing at https://egeria.mountainshares.us
MountainShares Commons	Live and in active testing
Red team testing	First external users onboarded
NPS engagement	Conceptual support indicated; formalization awaiting community letters
Development partner	Starry Eyes Media, Princeton WV
Target deployment	Mount Hope, April 2027
Public project documentation	https://github.com/H4HWV2011/msjarvis-public-docs

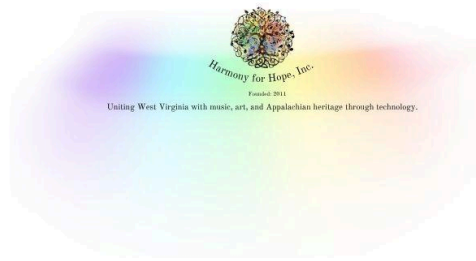
What Council Is Being Asked to Support

A Letter of Support stating that the City of Mount Hope:

- Recognizes the public value of the Mount Hope Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Pilot.
- Supports Harmony for Hope's use of the letter in grant applications and partnership discussions with NPS and other agencies.
- Supports continued exploration of Mount Hope as the anchor community for the pilot corridor.
- Is willing to participate in further conversations about site-specific implementation if funding is secured.

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What Council Is NOT Approving

For the city attorney's review, the Letter of Support does **not**:

- Obligate the City to provide funding of any kind.
- Authorize installation of hardware at any specific site.
- Waive permitting, zoning, property, procurement, or review requirements.
- Commit the City to a contract or operating agreement.
- Bind the City to support final implementation if later details are not acceptable.

This is a concept endorsement for grant and partnership development purposes only. All implementation details, site selections, and operational agreements would be brought back through normal City review processes if and when funding is secured.

Suggested Agenda Note

Request from Harmony for Hope for City Council consideration of a Letter of Support for the Mount Hope Heritage & Visitor Connectivity Pilot — a heritage tourism and community connectivity initiative being advanced for grant applications and partnership development with the National Park Service. No municipal funding, site authorization, or procurement is requested at this stage.